

Just to get the movie finished, Reeves ended up financing some of it himself. That turned out to be a lucrative decision. Reeves was paid between \$1 and \$2 million for each of the first three *John Wick* films, but is believed to have negotiated a percentage of backend points.

The first *John Wick* film (2014) was made on a shoestring budget of \$20 million, and did \$86 million in box office.^{[29](#)} Then came *John Wick: Chapter 2* (2017), which grossed \$175 million;^{[30](#)} then *John Wick: Chapter 3—Parabellum* (2019), which blew up to \$328 million;^{[31](#)} the latest, *John Wick: Chapter 4* (2023), released over the summer of that year, earned \$440 million at the box office.^{[32](#)}

Total box office for the first film and its three sequels is over a billion dollars. That's before the video games, comic books, television series, and spin-off films from the original are counted. *John Wick 5* heads to theaters in 2026—I wouldn't bet against it also doing big bucks at the box office.

By the time it's all said and done, the *John Wick* franchise is worth over \$2 billion. And it almost wasn't made, because none of the studio heads could see the commercial potential of one of the most bankable action stars in history spending two hours kicking ass and killing bad guys.

We have the benefit of hindsight, and so it seems obvious to us: How could *John Wick's* style of Hong Kong Gun Fu not be a hit? How did the studios lack the vision to see its potential? *John Wick* is yet another reminder about how little any of us know about what might happen in the future.



So the experts cannot tell what is going to happen with music or movies. What about television? All of those streaming companies seem to have the public's tastes figured out, right?

Let's see how much they can foretell the future...

²⁸ Danny Boyd, "When you hire stunt guys to direct the movie," CinemaStix, YouTube (April 1, 2023).